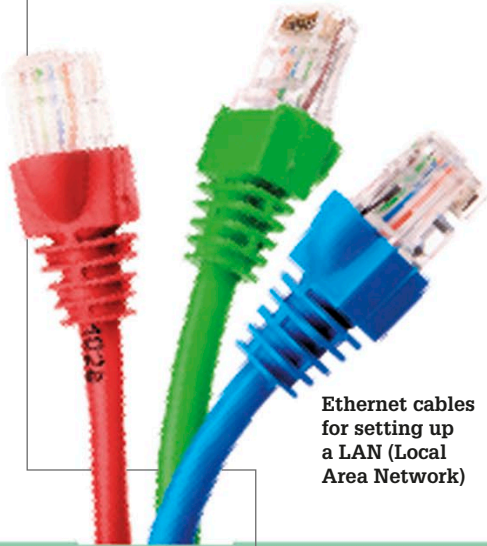


1973

Invention of Ethernet

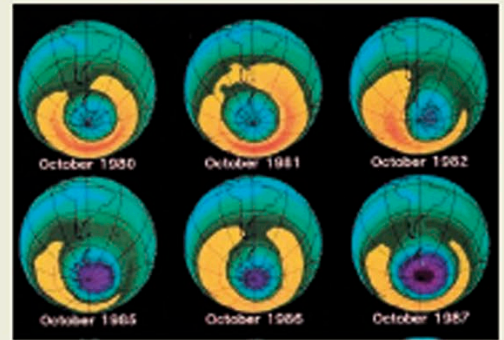
American engineer Robert Metcalfe developed an effective way of linking computers together via cables to form a fast, local network. Called the Ethernet, this technology allowed computers to exchange data easily as well as use the same printers or storage devices. Ethernet-based networks would become popular.



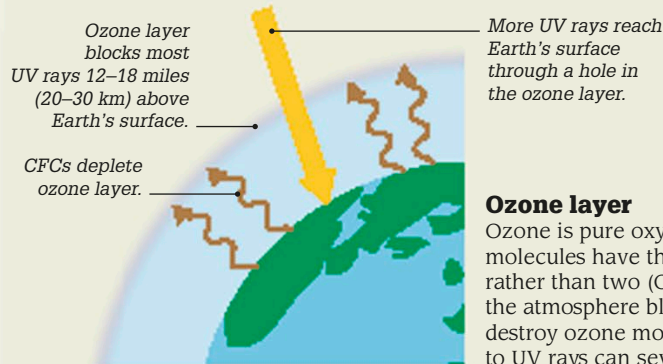
Ethernet cables for setting up a LAN (Local Area Network)

1974 OZONE HOLE

Scientists from the University of California, warned that chlorofluorocarbons (CFCs), chemicals used to make aerosol propellants and coolant liquids in refrigerators, might be depleting the atmosphere's ozone layer. This would allow the Sun's harmful ultraviolet (UV) rays to reach Earth's surface.



A hole in the ozone layer (purple) grew over a 13-year period, from 1979–1992.



Ozone layer

Ozone is pure oxygen. However, its molecules have three atoms each (O_3) rather than two (O_2). A layer of ozone in the atmosphere blocks UV rays, but CFCs destroy ozone molecules. Over-exposure to UV rays can severely harm life on Earth.

1973

First portable mobile phone

Produced by a team from the electronic communication company Motorola and led by American engineer Martin Cooper, the first prototype mobile phone, called the DynaTAC model, was unveiled in 1973. It was 9 in (23 cm) tall, weighed 2.42 lb (1.1 kg), and offered a talk-time of 20 minutes. Cooper made the first call on the phone to his rival Joel Engel at Bell Labs.



Martin Cooper with the original mobile phone, which held 30 electronic circuit boards inside

1974

Early ancestor

American paleontologist Donald Johanson discovered the fossil remains of a human ancestor—the oldest known relative at the time—that walked upright on two legs. The specimen, nicknamed “Lucy,” was found in Ethiopia and stood around 42.9 in (109 cm) tall. Classified as the early human species *Australopithecus afarensis*, she was dated as living around 3.2 million years ago.



Skull of “Lucy”

1973

CGI film

Computer-generated imagery (CGI) was used in a major motion picture for the first time in the science fiction film, *Westworld*, starring Yul Brynner. The graphics showed images as blocky pixels to depict the world as seen by a robot gunfighter inhabiting a Wild West theme park in the film.



Classic Rubik's cube with nine squares on each side

Rubik's cube

The popular Rubik's Cube puzzle was invented by Hungarian architect, Erno Rubik in 1974. There are about 43 quintillion (43 followed by 18 zeros) ways that the cube's 54 colored squares can be rearranged.

1975